# CSC-192 Seminar #4: Leadership in the Data Age

## Speaker: Joseph Taylor, Professor, School of Business, Sac State

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Q1) Explain the difference between Skills vs Attributes?

From the video, Joseph Taylor explained that skills are things you learn and practice, like coding, data analysis, or troubleshooting a computer. Attributes, on the other hand, are qualities that describe how you work such as being creative, problem-solving, or working well in a team. For example, two people might both have the skill to write code, but one person might be better at thinking outside the box, while another is very detail oriented.

Q2) Why are Attributes important for your Career Growth?

According to the speaker, attributes shape how a person fits into a job and how they solve problems. He shared that job descriptions often focus on skills, but the job requires attributes like creativity, adaptability, and understanding of business needs. For example, someone working with Hadoop isn't just using the tool; they need the ability to ask the right questions and understand how data helps a business.

Q3) Explain the Historical vs Current Capabilities of a Technology Leader?

Historically, technology leaders were mainly focused on their technical expertise, knowing how to build systems and solve technical problems. Taylor emphasized that modern tech leaders also need business knowledge and communication skills. Instead of just writing code, they must understand how technology connects with a company's goals and strategy.

Q4) Why is there a Distinctive Salary Difference between IT Professionals, even amongst those who have Similar experience? List the reasons

Taylor explained that salary differences among IT professionals, even with similar experience, come from several factors. Specialized skills, such as data governance, often lead to higher pay because they are in demand. Jobs that directly impact business revenue, like data analytics, tend to be valued more. Industry demand also plays a role, as there is a shortage of mid-level professionals in some fields, making those positions more competitive. Additionally, how well individuals present their skills and network within the industry can significantly influence their salary and career opportunities

Q5) List of two Companies who have successfully deployed their Technology & Business Strategies to gain a disproportionate Advantage in their market? Explain How?

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According to Joseph Taylor, Amazon and Walmart are two companies that have successfully used technology and business strategies to gain an advantage in their markets. Amazon leveraged its cloud computing service, AWS, to dominate both e-commerce and web services, allowing it to scale and generate massive revenue. Walmart, on the other hand, utilized data analytics to

optimize its supply chains, reducing costs and staying ahead in the retail industry by improving efficiency and decision-making.

Q6) List what makes you stand out in terms of: a) Your Strengths, b) Long Term Plan, c) Priorities.

When considering what makes me stand out, my strengths include problem-solving, adaptability, and leadership, which are essential in any technology-driven career. My long-term plan is to become a technology leader who can bridge the gap between IT and business, ensuring effective communication and strategic decision-making. My current priorities are to gain valuable industry experience, contribute to open-source projects, and build a strong professional network to support my career growth